

INVITATION TO TENDER RESPONSE

Website Development & Visual Identity Redevelopment

A clear, accessible and sustainable digital home for Timespan's museum, contemporary art, archive, research, shop, café and community programme.

Prepared for

Timespan Heritage & Arts Society

Prepared by

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Independent Lead Developer & Digital Product
Builder
Dar es Salaam, Tanzania

Submission deadline: 10 August 2026, 5:00pm UK time

Fixed professional fee: €20,500 excluding VAT • Delivery: 24 weeks from contract start

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1. Our understanding

Timespan does not need a decorative reskin. It needs a dependable public platform that makes a complex organisation understandable: a museum and archive, a contemporary art programme, a place of research and community learning, and an income-generating café, shop, ticketing and donation environment.

The current website and visual identity create barriers around navigation, legibility, publishing, collections visibility and online transactions. The response must therefore join service design, accessible visual communication and maintainable engineering—not treat them as separate exercises.

The proposition

Build one calm, legible and flexible digital system around the tasks Timespan's audiences actually need to complete: understand what Timespan is, plan a visit, discover events, book or buy, explore collections and research, donate, and remain connected.

Success will mean

- Visitors can understand Timespan's offer and find practical information without learning the organisation's internal structure.
- Events, collections, research, journal content, shop products and donations feel connected rather than fragmented.
- Typography, colour, hierarchy, keyboard navigation, forms and transactions meet WCAG 2.2 AA from the beginning.
- Staff can publish routine content confidently without developer involvement.
- The platform is lightweight, secure, measurable and economical to maintain.

The work will begin with listening and evidence. Existing analytics, content, staff workflows, the current and previous websites, and representative audience journeys will shape the architecture before visual or technical decisions are fixed.

A separate browser-based display explorer accompanies this response as an optional capability demonstration. Its 15 rendered views show how the same Timespan content can be presented in different visual languages; they are not final designs or a substitute for research. Information placement, architecture and the final visual direction will be agreed collaboratively before production coding.

2. Methodology and delivery

01 — Discover	Kick-off; review current and archived sites, analytics and brand material; staff workshop; audience conversations; technical and content inventory; accessibility and income-journey review. Output: discovery report, priorities and risk register.
02 — Define	Audience tasks, sitemap, content model, user journeys, CMS recommendation, integration plan, migration map and measurable acceptance criteria. Output: agreed specification and phased backlog.
03 — Design before build	A €100 structured design consultation, credited against the project fee if appointed, establishes priorities and content placement. Wireframes, typography, colour, interface system, logo review and prototypes then proceed through three consolidated review cycles. Production coding begins only after written design approval.
04 — Build	Component-led implementation; CMS roles and workflows; events, journal, shop, booking, donation, newsletter, search, collections presentation, analytics, privacy and SEO foundations; staging demonstrations at agreed milestones.
05 — Migrate & test	Structured migration from current and previous websites; redirects; content QA; accessibility review; device/browser testing; performance, security and transaction testing; staff acceptance testing.
06 — Launch & hand over	Controlled cutover with rollback plan; documentation and recorded training; credentials and source handover; analytics baseline; minimum four-week snagging period; maintenance roadmap.

Working rhythm

A shared decision log and task board will keep scope, responsibilities and approvals visible. Regular remote working sessions will be scheduled around Timespan's team. Important decisions will be demonstrated in the browser rather than hidden in technical documents. Additional review cycles or a material change to an approved direction would be agreed as a scope change before work proceeds.

International delivery

The proposed delivery model is remote-first. Workshops, research sessions, reviews, training and handover can be conducted by video conference. Any essential in-person requirement would be agreed separately before contract signature and is not included in the proposed fee.

3. Experience and system approach

The proposed platform will be designed as a reusable system, not a collection of one-off pages. A structured CMS and shared component library will allow Timespan to present different programmes consistently while preserving the character of each activity.

Recommended functional architecture

- Clear primary journeys: Visit, What’s On, Museum & Collections, Art Programme, Research & Archive, Shop, Support and About.
- Reusable content types for events, exhibitions, collection stories, research, journal posts, people, opportunities and visitor information.
- Accessible site search and filters, with relationships between events, objects, research and programme material.
- Proportionate integration with the collection catalogue: begin with stable linking or selected records, then deepen only where evidence justifies it.
- Ecommerce, ticketing/booking and donations selected during discovery around staff workflow, fees, data protection and accessibility—not novelty.
- Consent-aware analytics and simple reporting focused on visits, bookings, sales, donations, content discovery and search success.

Visual identity

The identity work will move from stretched, decorative typography toward a legible and durable system. The process will define an accessible type hierarchy, contrast-tested palette, spacing and wayfinding rules, image behaviour, flexible programme templates and logo refinements suitable for screen, print, signage and small-scale use.

Technical direction

WordPress remains a sensible baseline because staff already use it and Timespan wants independence after launch. We will first audit the present host. If it supports secure API connections, scheduled tasks, backups and the agreed operational requirements, it can be retained. If not, we will compare Timespan-owned managed WordPress and DigitalOcean options by three-year cost, support, security, environmental commitments, performance, UK/EU data requirements and exit portability. The implementation will minimise plug-ins, separate content from presentation, use version-controlled custom components and document every recurring cost.

Transactions and future capability

Ticketing, ecommerce, donations and refunds will use established payment processors so card data is not stored by the website. During discovery we will compare Timespan’s existing tools with options such as Stripe, PayPal and appropriate ticketing services on accessibility, UK availability, transaction fees, Gift Aid workflow, reconciliation, refunds, data ownership and staff usability. The architecture will retain secure API integration points for later automation or AI-assisted services without making an unrequested AI feature part of the core launch.

Ownership

Timespan will receive the source code, CMS and hosting credentials, final visual-identity assets, logo files, templates, documentation and exportable content required to operate without supplier lock-in.

4. Accessibility, sustainability and assurance

Accessibility is a delivery criterion at every stage rather than a final automated scan. The target is WCAG 2.2 AA, supported by manual checks and representative task testing.

Accessibility practice

- Semantic structure, meaningful headings, landmarks, link purpose and logical reading order.
- Full keyboard operation, visible focus, skip links and accessible navigation patterns.
- Contrast-tested colour and typography; responsive zoom and reflow; reduced-motion support.
- Accessible forms, validation, checkout, booking and donation journeys.
- Alternative text and guidance for audio, video, transcripts and collection material.
- Testing with automated tools, keyboard-only use and screen-reader checks; collaboration with Timespan's access consultant and public evaluation sessions.
- Editorial training so accessibility survives after handover.

Sustainable digital practice

- Lean templates, compressed responsive media and limited third-party scripts.
- A measured performance budget and Core Web Vitals monitoring.
- Avoidance of unnecessary animation, heavy libraries and duplicate content requests.
- Hosting options compared on reliability, location, support, cost and environmental commitments.
- A maintainable design system that reduces redesign churn and technical waste.

Security and privacy

The plan includes role-based access, multi-factor authentication where supported, encrypted transport, controlled updates, routine backups and tested restoration, dependency review, spam protection, privacy-conscious analytics, cookie controls, incident contacts and a documented maintenance schedule. Payment details will remain with established compliant processors rather than the website application.

Operational health reporting

Timespan may choose a concise morning health report by email or Telegram, covering availability, SSL status, backup completion, security/update state, performance and transaction checks. A private administration health panel will also provide manual on-demand checks and incident history. Reporting channels, retention and escalation rules will be agreed with Timespan; no customer or payment data will be sent through Telegram. Monitoring setup is included, while any third-party monitoring subscription is disclosed and approved separately.

Quality gates

Architecture approval → design/accessibility approval → staging feature acceptance → migration reconciliation → launch readiness review → post-launch acceptance.

5. Team and relevant work

The tender will be delivered and led by Edward Mathew Mkingule as the accountable point of contact. This is an independent-lead proposal: Edward remains responsible for discovery, architecture, implementation, quality, communication and handover. Any specialist support later agreed with Timespan will be disclosed transparently.

Edward Mathew Mkingule

Independent lead developer & digital product builder. Full-stack delivery across responsive interfaces, Next.js/React, Python and Node.js services, relational data, role-based systems, API integrations, deployment, automation and technical operations. Based in Dar es Salaam and available worldwide.

Delivery model

A single accountable lead across the full lifecycle, supported by browser-based demonstrations, documented decisions and structured acceptance gates. If Timespan and Edward agree that specialist review would materially strengthen a stage, the person, responsibility and cost will be disclosed before engagement.

Selected evidence

DukaOS

Live bilingual, mobile-first POS and retail-management SaaS: sales, inventory, debt, expenses, roles, branches, ecommerce, reporting, offline workflows and AI assistance. <https://dukaos.com>

Atlas Digital Vault

Live web and Android document-security product with client-side encryption, document organisation, reminders, secure sharing, multilingual access and subscription journeys. <https://atlasdigitalvault.app>

Korvia display studies

A live design system and portfolio of responsive interface studies demonstrating content modelling, visual range and deployment. <https://oriondrayke.github.io/korvia/>

Vino & Views UI audition

Forty independently rendered interface directions in a browser comparison environment, demonstrating systematic visual exploration rather than a single template. <https://oriondrayke.github.io/vinoandviews-ui-lab/>

Timespan display explorer

Fifteen Timespan-specific rendered homepage views using public Timespan content. These are discussion aids—not final design, architecture or unpaid specification. <https://oriondrayke.github.io/korvia/proposals/timespan-views/>

Litagatoro

Human-in-the-loop service infrastructure with a Python SDK, MCP integration and smart-contract components—evidence of systems thinking, documentation and API delivery. <https://github.com/oriondrayke/Litagatoro>

Client reference

Erick Mathew Mkingule — client reference associated with the DukaOS and Atlas Digital Vault product work.

Email: erickmathew0021@gmail.com WhatsApp: +255 788 467 987

Live product links are provided above; confidential implementation details can be discussed at interview.

6. Timeline, fee and payment

The programme below completes within Timespan's maximum six-month period. Exact dates will be baselined at kick-off around content availability, integrations and approval windows.

Stage	Indicative timing	Milestone
Discovery	Weeks 1-3	Research, audit, workshop, risks and discovery report
Definition	Weeks 4-5	Architecture, content model, integrations and specification
Design & identity	Weeks 6-10	Wireframes, visual system, logo review and prototypes
Build	Weeks 11-17	CMS, components, transactions, search and integrations
Migration & QA	Weeks 18-21	Content, redirects, accessibility, security and acceptance
Launch & support	Weeks 22-24	Training, handover, launch and four-week snagging overlap

Fee proposal

Workstream	Fee
Discovery, workshops and user research	€1,700
Information architecture, user journeys and UX	€1,600
Visual identity development and logo refresh	€3,200
WordPress design and development	€6,500
Ecommerce, ticketing, donations and integrations	€1,800
Content and data migration	€1,200
WCAG 2.2 AA assurance, security and testing	€1,300
Project management and meetings	€1,400
Training, documentation and handover	€800
Launch and four-week post-launch support	€1,000
Total fixed professional fee	€20,500 excluding VAT

Proposed payments against completed stages: 10% on contract and kick-off; 20% after discovery/specification approval; 20% after design and identity approval; 25% after functional staging acceptance; 15% after migration, testing and training acceptance; 10% after launch, handover and snagging acceptance. The separate €100 pre-build consultation is credited to the first project invoice if appointed.

For tender comparison, €20,500 was approximately £17,780 using the ECB reference rate on 30 July 2026; the contractual currency and exchange treatment will be agreed before signature. Third-party hosting, payment, ticketing, premium plug-in, font, AI-provider and subscription charges are excluded and require Timespan's approval. Timespan should own and pay supplier accounts directly. Travel and accommodation are excluded.

7. Risks, dependencies and confirmation

Content volume	A late or unclear migration set can compress testing. Mitigation: inventory and ownership decisions begin in discovery; migration waves and freeze dates are agreed early.
Integrations	Ticketing, ecommerce, catalogue and donation tools may introduce fees or constraints. Mitigation: validate APIs, accessibility, data ownership and exit routes before selection.
Hosting & monitoring	The current host may restrict server-level or background services. Mitigation: audit first, retain it where suitable, or present costed Timespan-owned alternatives; keep monitoring data minimal and operational.
Accessibility	Compliance can decay through content and third-party tools. Mitigation: component standards, manual checks, editorial training and a documented audit cycle.
Decision latency	Distributed feedback can create rework. Mitigation: named approvers, consolidated comments, decision deadlines and browser-based demonstrations.
Remote delivery	Time zones and any essential site activity must be explicit. Mitigation: overlapping UK working hours, recorded sessions, clear response windows and early agreement on any physical requirement.
Supplier assurance	Insurance and international contracting requirements must be confirmed. Mitigation: obtain Timespan's required coverage limits and contracting conditions before final submission/appointment.

Assumptions requiring confirmation

- Timespan accepts a Tanzania-based independent lead and named collaborators using a remote-first delivery model.
- No mandatory in-person attendance is required; any optional visit would be separately agreed and funded.
- Professional-indemnity and public-liability insurance limits will be provided so compliant cover can be evidenced before contract signature.
- Timespan will provide timely access to analytics, current suppliers, CMS/export material, brand files, catalogue information and decision-makers.
- The 15-view Timespan explorer demonstrates presentation range only. Final placement, architecture and design require discovery, consultation, accessibility review and Timespan's written approval.
- Erick Mathew Mkingule has permitted his listed email and WhatsApp details to be used as the client reference; insurance evidence/status will be confirmed before submission.

Availability and commitment

Edward Mathew Mkingule is available to begin as soon as Timespan completes its appointment process and is ready to commence. The delivery baseline will be agreed at mobilisation. Edward will act as Timespan's single accountable point of contact, work transparently, protect Timespan's ownership, document decisions and leave behind a platform staff can operate with confidence.

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